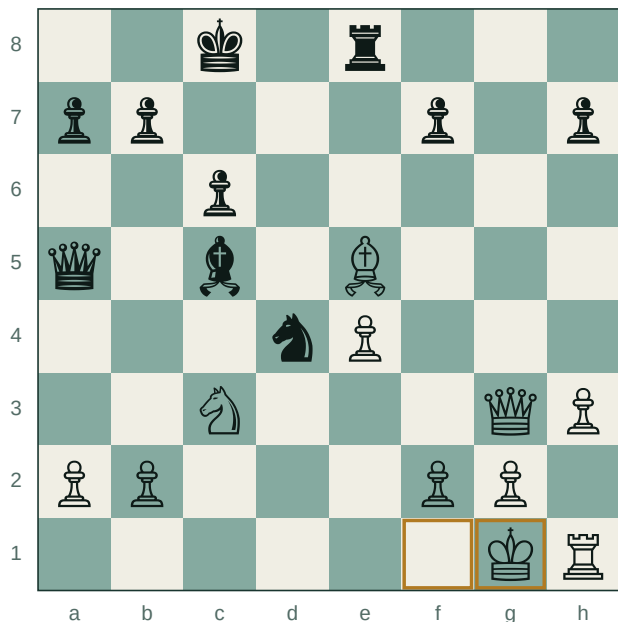


Calculated sacrifices: Black, move 20

Calculated sacrifices

Black to move



Previous move: 20.Kg1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

20...Rxe5 21. Qxe5 Nf3+ 22. gxf3 Bxf2+ 23. Kxf2 Qxe5

20...Rxe5 The rook captures the bishop on e5. Recorded reply: **21.Qxe5**.

21...Nf3+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From f3 it attacks king on g1 and queen on e5. Recorded reply: **22.gxf3**.

22...Bxf2+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. The changed line means the queen on a5 attacks the queen on e5. Recorded reply: **23.Kxf2**.

23...Qxe5 The queen captures the queen on e5.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +2**: the balance goes from -1 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on g1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.